Final Action Agenda/Minutes are supplemented by audio and video recordings of the meetings, as well as transcripts. Video recordings of Village Council meetings from June 8, 2016, forward, as well as agendas, staff reports, resolutions, ordinances, and other documents related to the meetings can be viewed online at https://estero-fl.gov/agendas/ at the corresponding meeting date.

APPROVED BY COUNCIL
SEPTEMBER 23, 2026

VILLAGE COUNCIL BUDGET AND SPECIAL MEETING

Village of Estero Council Chambers
9401 Corkscrew Palms Circle
Estero, FL 33928

September 9, 2026 5:05 p.m.

1. CALL TO ORDER

INVOCATION

Worship Leader Drew DiRoma Estero Church

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

ROLL CALL

Present: Mayor Joanne Ribble - District 1, Councilmember Jeff Hunt- District 2, Councilmember Jon McLain - District 3, Councilmember Lori Fayhee – District 4, Councilmember Rafael Lopez - District 5, Councilmember Jim Ward - District 6, and Vice Mayor George Zalucki - District 7.

Also present
Village Manager Steve Sarkozy, Village Attorney Robert Eschenfelder, Deputy Village Manager Ryan Eggleston, Public Works Director David Williams, Assistance Community Development Director/Assistant to Village Manager Michael Manning, Deputy Village Clerk Tammy Duran, and Village Clerk Carol Sacco.

2. FIRST PUBLIC BUDGET HEARINGS

(a) Resolution No. 2026-18 Adopting the Tentative Millage Rate and Tentative Levying of Ad Valorem Taxes

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, Adopting the Tentative Millage Rate and Tentative Levying of Ad Valorem Taxes for the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, for Fiscal Year 2026-2027; Establishing the Date, Time and Place for a Public Hearing to Adopt the Final Millage Rate and Final Levying of Ad Valorem Taxes for Fiscal Year 2026-2027; and Providing an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmember Ward

Public Comments
None

Motion: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-18.

Motion by: Vice Mayor Zalucki
Seconded by: Councilmember Lopez

Action: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-18.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(b) Resolution No. 2026-19 Adopting the Tentative Budget for Fiscal Year 2026-2027

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Lee County, Florida, Adopting the Tentative Budget for Fiscal Year 2026-2027; and Providing an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmember Hunt

Public Comments
Mark Novitski, Bella Terra

Motion: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-19

Motion by: Councilmember Hunt
Seconded by: Councilmember Lopez

Action: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-19.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

3. PROCLAMATIONS

(a) Dr. Lawrence Antonucci Retirement

4. APPROVAL OF AGENDA, ADDITIONS, AND DELETIONS

Motion: Motion to approve agenda with the deletion of agenda item 8(g) Agreement with the Estero Forever Foundation for management of Estero RiverPark.

Motion by: Vice Mayor Zalucki
Seconded by: Councilmember Fayhee

Action: Approved agenda with the deletion of agenda item 8(g) Agreement with the Estero Forever Foundation for management of Estero RiverPark.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

5. PUBLIC COMMENT ON NON-AGENDA ITEMS

Mark Novitski, Bella Terra
Dr. Nora DeMeers, FGCU
Beth Castro, Estero (BERT)

6. CONSENT AGENDA

(a) July 2, 2026 Village Council Meeting Minutes
(b) Financial Report for Month ended June 2026

Motion: Motion to approve consent agenda.

Motion by: Councilmember Fayhee
Seconded by: Councilmember Lopez

Action: Approved consent agenda.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

7. CONSIDERATION OF ITEMS DEFERRED FROM CONSENT AGENDA

None

8. ACTION ITEMS

(a) Resolution No. 2026-20 authorizing the Village Manager or Designee to execute Community Development Block Grant- Disaster Recovery (CDBG-DR) contracts, contract amendments, and related program documentation

Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Florida, Authorizing the Village Manager or Designee to Execute Community Development Block Grant-Disaster Recovery (CDBG_DR) Contracts, Contract Amendments, and Related Program Documentation; Making Related Findings; Providing for Severability; And Providing for an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

Council Questions or Comments
None.

Public Comments
None

Motion: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-20.

Motion by: Councilmember Ward
Seconded by: Councilmember McLain

Action: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-20.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(b) Resolution No. 2026-21 Authorizing exercise of eminent domain to allow Williams Road roundabout project.

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Florida, Authorizing the Use of Eminent Domain for the Acquisition of Certain Real Property of Fountain Lakes to Facilitate the Construction of the Williams Road Roundabout Project; Making Related Findings; Providing for Severability and for an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
Robert Eschenfelder, Village Attorney

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmember McLain and Vice Mayor Zalucki

Public Comments
None

Motion: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-21.

Motion by: Councilmember McLain
Seconded by: Councilmember Fayhee

Action: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-21.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(c) Resolution No. 2026-22 Supporting the construction of a noise wall and enhanced landscaping by FDOT related to the Interstate 75 expansion project within the Village

A Resolution of the Village Council of the Village of Estero, Florida, Supporting the Construction by the Florida Department of Transportation of a Noise Wall for the Brooks Community; Making Related Findings; Providing for Severability and Providing for an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
David Willems, Public Works Director
Robert Eschenfelder, Village Attorney

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmembers Ward, Hunt, McLain, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble

Public Comments
Steve Chappell, Shadow Wood
Len Reid, Copperleaf

Motion: Motion to adopt Resolution No. 2026-22.

Motion by: Councilmember Ward
Seconded by: Councilmember Fayhee

Action: Adopted Resolution No. 2026-22.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(d) Estero RiverPark Phase 2 Path Construction Contract

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
David Willems, Public Works Director

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.

Public Comments
Dr. Nora Demers, FGCU

Motion: Motion to approve award of Contract 26036 with Honc Industries to construct RiverPark Phase 2 Paths for $244,075, approve a $24,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the contract and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contract on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Motion by: Councilmember Lopez
Seconded by: Councilmember Hunt

Action: Approved award of Contract 26036 with Honc Industries to construct RiverPark Phase 2 Paths for $244,075, approve a $24,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the contract and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contract on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(e) RiverPark Trails Non-Native Plant Treatment

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
David Willems, Public Works Director

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmember McLain and Mayor Ribble

Public Comments
Dr. Nora Demers, FGCU

Motion: Motion to approve award of Invitation to Bid 10626 with Earth Balance to provide non-native plant treatment services to RiverPark for $90,895 over five years, approve a $9,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the purchase order and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contract on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Motion by: Councilmember Hunt
Seconded by: Vice Mayor Zalucki

Action: Approved award of Invitation to Bid 10626 with Earth Balance to provide non-native plant treatment services to RiverPark for $90,895 over five years, approve a $9,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the purchase order and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the contract on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(f) Broadway Ave West Improvements Change Order 01

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
David Willems, Public Works Director

Council Questions or Comments
Vice Mayor Zalucki

Public Comments
None

Motion: Motion to approve Contract No. 26010 Change Order 01 for CW3 Engineering to provide professional services for the design and permitting of utility improvements along Broadway Ave West for $382,820, approve a $38,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the Change Order and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the Change Order on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Motion by: Councilmember McLain
Seconded by: Councilmember Hunt

Action: Approved Contract No. 26010 Change Order 01 for CW3 Engineering to provide professional services for the design and permitting of utility improvements along Broadway Ave West for $382,820, approve a $38,000 contingency for additional services that may be required to complete the project, and authorize the Village Manager to sign the Change Order and other additional implementing documents within the scope of the Change Order on behalf of the Village of Estero Council.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

(g) Agreement with the Estero Forever Foundation for management of Estero RiverPark.

Removed from Agenda

9. SECOND READING AND PUBLIC HEARING

(a) Ordinance No. 2026-07 Requiring Painting Permits for Certain Non-Residential Structures

An Ordinance of the Village of Estero, Florida, Creating a New § 7-7 of the Village Code Related to Painting Permits; Making Related Findings; Providing for Severability; and Providing for an Effective Date.

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager
Robert Eschenfelder, Village Attorney

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmember Hunt

Public Comments
None

Motion: Motion to adopt Ordinance No. 2026-07.

Motion by: Councilmember Fayhee
Seconded by: Councilmember Lopez

Action: Adopted Ordinance No. 2026-07.

Vote: (Roll Call)
Aye: Councilmembers Hunt, McLain, Fayhee, Lopez, Ward, Vice Mayor Zalucki, and Mayor Ribble.
Nay:
Abstentions:

10. COUNCIL COMMUNICATIONS / FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS

Councilmembers McLain, Lopez, Vice Mayor Zalucki and Mayor Ribble.

Public Comment (Council Approved)
Beth Castro, Estero BERT

Consensus for Village Logo to be added to BERT's Jersey for their Fund-Raising Bike Ride on November 15th.

Consensus for the Councilmembers' signatures to be added to the letter to Veterans on Honor Flight. Letter will be sent to Council before mailing.

11. VILLAGE ATTORNEY'S REPORT

None

12. VILLAGE MANAGER'S REPORT

None

Adjourn Regular Session at 6:35 pm and Convene at 6:35 pm Workshop Item

13. WORKSHOP

(a) Conceptual Financing – Special Obligation Revenue Bonds

Staff Presentation/Comments
Steve Sarkozy, Village Manager

Presentation/Information by
Mickey Johnston, PRAG

Council Questions or Comments
Councilmembers Hunt and Ward

Public Comments
None

14. ADJOURNMENT at 6:48 pm

Motion by Mayor Ribble

ATTEST: VILLAGE OF ESTERO, FLORIDA

By: _____ By: _____

Carol Sacco, CMC, Village Clerk Joanne Ribble, Mayor

(td/CS)

For an official copy of the signed minutes, please submit a Public Record Request.